
UNIT 5 SYSTEMS APPROACH*

Structure

- 5.0 Objectives
- 5.1 Introduction
- 5.2 The Concept of System
- 5.3 Systems Approach to International Relations
 - 5.3.1 Systems Approach of Morton Kaplan
 - 5.3.2 Systems Approach of Kenneth Waltz
 - 5.3.3 Systems Approach of Keohane and Nye
 - 5.3.4 Systems Approach of Alexander Wendt
 - 5.3.5 Systems Approach of Immanuel Wallerstein
- 5.4 Let Us Sum Up
- 5.5 References
- 5.6 Answers to Check Your Progress Exercise

5.0 OBJECTIVES

The aim of this Unit is to study the Systems approach to International Relations. After going through this unit, you would be able to:

- Explain the origins of the Systems approach
- Narrate the application of Systems approach to International Relations and
- Examine the salient features of various Systemic theories in International Relations

5.1 INTRODUCTION

The Systems approach became the hallmark of Political Science and International Relations (IR) during the Cold War period. The complexities in the Cold War period, such as the emergence of the technologies of mass destruction (i.e., atom bombs, and other lethal weapons), inventions in the fields of cybernetics, computer science, etc., emphasized the requirement of an integrated and comprehensive approach to address the complex problems unearthed during the Cold War period. This led to the development of the General System Theory (GST) and the application of Systems approach to the various branches of natural and social sciences. The Systems approach, in general, believes that each and every System in the universe is interconnected and exert influence over one another. Therefore, we need to examine the dynamics of Systems to understand a particular phenomenon in the universe.

5.2 THE CONCEPT OF SYSTEM

The systems approach is a framework to understand a phenomenon in terms of the wholeness of a system, its self-organization, relationships, and interactions among its various elements. This approach emerged as a critic of reductionist

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tradition in science, which treats the natural as well as the social world as a fragmented whole, thereby looking at the elements to understand a phenomenon. In short, the Systems approach looks at the dynamics within a system and its influence over other systems. In International Relations (IR), a systems approach is used to understand a phenomenon by examining the function of the international system, instead of analysing the developments happening in its elements (i.e., nation states).

A system can be defined as ‘an interconnected set of elements that is coherently organized in a way that achieves something’. The four distinguishing features of a system are: elements, interconnections, function or purpose, and a regulating force. Take the example of our digestive system. It has elements such as teeth, enzymes, stomach, and intestines. Elements in our digestive system are interconnected through the physical flow of food. The function or purpose of our digestive system is to digest food and extract basic nutrients from it and to transfer those nutrients into another system of our body, i.e., the bloodstream. Our digestive system is being regulated by the chemical signals. Thus, everything composed of interconnected elements has a function or purpose, driven by a regulating force, can be treated as a system. Human beings are the part of a number of systems in society and each system is interconnected and exerts its influence over the other systems in society.

The Systems approach is the intellectual child of the General Systems Theory (GST), which was introduced by the Austrian-born Canadian biologist Ludwig von Bertalanffy (1901-1972). Bertalanffy's magnum opus, *General Systems Theory: Foundation, Development, Application* (1968), is the canonical text of the Systems theory. According to him, the System is ‘a complex of components in mutual interaction’ and he set forth the GST as a discipline focusing on the formulation of principles valid for Systems in general. During the time Bertalanffy was working on GST, the world was undergoing unprecedented incidents such as the Cold War rivalry between two antagonistic blocs, and the threat of the weapons of mass destruction. Many people worried that the world was on the verge of destruction. At the same time, advancements in the fields of science and technology especially in cybernetics indicated the possibility of applying knowledge for controlling human behaviour and society. In 1949, James Grier Miller, Head of the Department of Psychology at the University of Chicago, coined the term ‘behavioral science’ as a field of the integrated study of the biological, psychological, and social dimensions of human behaviour. Then the focus of some sections in academia shifted to conduct interdisciplinary research on human behaviour and social conflicts. In order to achieve this goal, with the support and funding of the Ford Foundation, the Center for Advanced Study in the Behavioral Sciences (CASBS) was established, in Stanford, California in 1954. Several scholars who were interested in peace and building a comprehensive theory about human behaviour and social conflicts were invited to associate with the Center. Among scholars who played a major role in advancing General Systems Theory along with Ludwig von Bertalanffy were, the economist and peace activist Kenneth Boulding, psychologist James Grier Miller, the physiologist Ralph Gerard, and the mathematician-biologist Anatol Rapoport. In 1956, they established the Society for General Systems Research (SGSR) and it began to organize annual conferences and to publish a *General Systems Yearbook* since then. Building on the General Systems framework, James Grier Miller launched the journal, *Behavioral Science*, in 1956, and Boulding initiated

the *Journal of Conflict Resolution* in 1957. Thus, GST and behavioural science went hand in hand as an integrated and interdisciplinary approach to study and control social relations.

The GST was developed as a discipline to formulate general principles of Systems so that all branches of natural and social sciences can develop their own systems theories. Kenneth Boulding made a bold statement when he said that GST is the skeleton of science which is aimed at providing a structure of systems on which each particular discipline can fit its own flesh and blood. Thus, GST seems to be appealing to the leading scholars of that time and they adapted it to their concerned disciplines. For instance, Talcott Parsons applied GST to sociology, Bela H. Banathy to linguistics, and Howard T. Odum to ecology - the list continues. The scholars of political science and IR also adapted General Systems Theory to their disciplines and the following part of this Unit examines it in detail.

5.3 SYSTEMS APPROACH TO INTERNATIONAL RELATIONS

The Systems approach to IR marks a contrast to the traditional approach, which focuses only on the domestic factors such as the ideology of a nation-state, the character of the head of the state, and other internal matters that influence the behaviour of nation-states. Thus, the core of the systems approach to the study of IR, lies in the belief that the international system is an integrated whole, which is made of its structure and nation-states. The study of IR should be focused on the functions of the international system and its regulating force rather than examining the domestic factors of nation-states.

5.3.1 Systems Approach of Morton Kaplan

The first major work that presented the systems approach to the discipline of International Relations was Morton A. Kaplan's *System and Process in International Politics* (1957). Unlike Easton and Almond, whose works mainly centred on political systems within nation-states and their interactions with other political systems across the world, Kaplan's study was focused on the international system. During those days, the world was in the shadow of the Cold War, which divided nation-states into two rival camps: between the US-led capitalist bloc and the Soviet socialist bloc. As a result, Morton Kaplan envisaged the structure of the international system in the form of a polarized world.

Kaplan holds that there is a certain degree of regularity in the behaviour of nation-states' within the international system. This regularity reveals a level of internal coherence, which helps a scholar of International Relations to construct the models of the international system. According to Kaplan, it is possible to predict the evolution of various models of the international system with the help of examining previous models of the international system.

Kaplan sets forth six distinct international systems out of which, the balance of power system, and the loose bipolar system had existed in history, and the rest of the systems are hypothetical, which could emerge from the end of the bipolar system. The six systems are explained below.

- A) **The Balance of Power System:** A period between the eighteenth century and 1914 (the beginning year of the First World War) had been considered as the golden era of the balance of power system. This system featured a multipolar dynamic of five dominant European powers of similar strength. These powers sought to enhance their capacities through diplomatic channels rather than military means. There were occasions of war among these powers, but it came to an end when there was a threat of the destruction of one of these powers. Hence, it was clear that they never intended to alter the system; instead, the primary goal was to preserve the system. When one power attempted to dominate the others, then other powers formed an alliance against it. When one major actor had suffered a defeat, the other powers did not exclude that state. Instead, the defeated state was reintegrated into the system by other states.
- B) **The Loose Bipolar System:** Unlike the balance of power system, the loose bipolar system featured diverse actors during the period of Cold War. The basic structure of the system was two large rival blocs led by two superpowers: the United States of America and the Soviet Union. These two blocs were radically different in terms of ideologies: democratic capitalism and communism. In addition to the two blocs, there were also other actors such as Non-Aligned states and international organizations such as the United Nations. Both the superpowers avoided a direct war due to the threat of nuclear destruction via counter-attack (according to the second strike doctrine).
- C) **The Tight Bipolar System:** The tight bipolar system has so many characteristics in common with the loose bipolar system. For instance, the structure of the tight bipolar system is the two rival blocs and the actors of both blocs are hierarchically organized. The tight bipolar system will be transformed into a loose bipolar system if both actors are non-hierarchically organized. Another important feature is the role of the other actors than the bloc actors. International organizations such as the United Nations will be marginalized and Non-Aligned states will either lose their significance or will disappear in the tight bipolar system.
- D) **The Universal System:** The universal system is possible when the bipolar system disappears and international organizations such as the United Nations become so powerful in maintaining world peace. This system resembles Immanuel Kant's idea of the confederation of republican states which follow rule of law. What makes the universal system unique is its nature and functions. The universal system will be an integrated and solidarity system. It will have the mechanisms to perform judicial, economic, political and administrative functions. These functions may be performed by either the United Nations or any such international organization. This system is featured by a high level of cross-border cooperation and humanitarian interventions.
- E) **The Hierarchical System:** This system comes into existence with the demise of the bipolar system through the breakup of one of the two blocs. Then the international order is reorganized into a political hierarchy and the ideology of the remaining bloc is enforced upon the members of the collapsed bloc. Depending on the ideology of the remaining bloc and the role of the international organizations in the changed scenario, the hierarchic system will be either democratic or authoritarian.

- F) The Unit Veto System:** The unit veto system is one in which all states possess the capability to destroy one another, but all of them are aware of the consequences of the attack: that aggression will trigger a retaliatory attack. The consciousness about the retaliatory action discourages each and every nation-state from attacking other countries. Kaplan held that the advancements in the fields of communication and technology minimize the danger of an accidental war under the unit veto system.

Check Your Progress Exercise 1

Note: i) Use the space given below for your answer,

ii) See the end of the Unit for tips for your answer.

- 1) Name the six international systems set forth by Morton Kaplan.

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5.3.2 Systems Approach of Kenneth Waltz

Kenneth Waltz, the founding father of Neorealism or 'Structural Realism', has immensely contributed to the advancement of the Systems approach to IR. In his 1954 book, *Man, the State, and War: A Theoretical Analysis*, Waltz introduced three levels of analysis in international relations. They are, respectively, the selfish nature of man; the behaviour of states and institutions; and the pressure of the international system. Waltz further stated that the issues of high politics, such as war are determined by the international system. According to Waltz, the war is instigated by the international system, and it could not be eliminated by changing the behaviour of states' leaders and nation-states. Therefore, in this book Waltz made an argument that an analysis of the international system was needed to understand international politics. It was in his 1979 book, *Theory of International Politics*, that Waltz set forth the major canons of Neorealism and the salient features of his Systems approach as explained below.

- A) The Composition of the International System:** According to Waltz, the international system is composed of its structure and its interacting units, i.e., nation-states. He holds that structure of the international system is made of three elements: (i) ordering principle, (ii) the function of the units, and (iii) the distribution of material capabilities. The first element of the structure is its ordering principle, and according to Waltz, it is anarchic. This is due to the absence of a world government for maintaining international peace. In the absence of a world government, there is no mechanism to ensure the survival of nation-states other than a self-help system. The third attribute of the structure is the distribution of material capabilities among units in the international system. Material capabilities are primarily military weapons and manpower. In addition to that economic resources that support the enhancement of military infrastructure are also treated as a material capability.

- B) Distribution of Material Capabilities as the Regulating Force:** Like the 'invisible hand' in the market, the structure of the international system regulates the behaviour of nation-states through the distribution of material capabilities. How does it work? We have already seen that the ordering principle of the structure is anarchy, and self-help is the only means to ensure the security of the nation-states. These two factors lock nation-states in a security dilemma and instigate them to augment capabilities for balancing the power of their rivals. The third attribute of the structure is the distribution of material capabilities. Here material capabilities function as a regulating force or catalyst for developments in international politics. For instance, suppose when one of the nation-states augments its capabilities, then its potential rivals are compelled to scale-up their military strength, make alliances or bandwagon with a more powerful state so that they can ensure their own security. Sometimes the disproportionate distribution of capabilities may make some states more powerful than their rivals and it may instigate war. However, due to nation-states being rational actors their behaviour is based on the logic of the consequences. In sum, material capabilities act as catalysts for war, diplomatic initiatives, military alliances, and bandwagoning.
- C) Autonomy of the International System:** One of the major contributions of Waltz's Neorealism is the severing of the link between the 'low politics' (i.e., politics within nation-states and the 'high politics' (politics of the international system). All issues of national or local importance come under the purview of 'low politics'. For instance, unemployment, inflation, environmental issues, human rights, etc., are part of low politics. 'High politics' refers to the issues related to international politics such as war, defence, national security, and foreign policy. According to Waltz, low politics cannot affect international politics. Moreover, nation-states are like-units, therefore, the nature of political systems (i.e., authoritarian, democratic or ideological orientations), size of nation-states and their capabilities cannot make any difference in their function in the international system. The function of all nation-states is to ensure their national security in a condition of international anarchy. Therefore, irrespective of the internal dimensions of politics all nation-states behave in the same manner with regard to their foreign relations. By making a clear distinction between national politics and international politics, Waltz argues that the structure of the international system regulates the behaviour of nation-states through the distribution of material capabilities. In sum, Waltz suggests that the structure of the international system regulates the behaviour of nation-states and it is not possible that nation-states regulate the function of the international system. Hence, Waltz argues that in order to understand the developments in international politics one has to examine the external dimensions of politics (the dynamics in the international system). As far as Waltz is concerned, focusing on domestic factors for understanding international politics is a reductionist approach. Instead, Waltz sets forth Neorealism as a framework to understand international politics by examining the dynamics in the international system, and thereby, seeks to establish the autonomy of the international system.

Note: i) Use the space given below for your answer,

ii) See the end of the unit for tips for your answer.

1) What are the salient features of the systems approach of Kenneth Waltz?

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5.3.3 Systems Approach of Keohane and Nye

Works of Robert O. Keohane and Joseph S. Nye set forth Neoliberal understanding of the international system. Their joint book, *Power and Interdependence: World Politics in Transition* (1977, 2001), is one of the earliest works to systematically examine the processes that later came to be known as globalization. The opening statement of the book is that “We live in an era of interdependence”, owing to the increasing pace of cross-border transportation, communication, and trade. In this book, Keohane and Nye define interdependence as ‘situations characterized by reciprocal effects among countries or among actors in different countries. This book further elaborates the neoliberal idea of ‘complex’ interdependence and its implications for international politics, especially its functions in an anarchical international system. Another classic text of Neoliberalism in IR is Keohane’s, *After Hegemony: Cooperation and Discord in the World Political Economy* (1984). As its title indicates this book proposes that cooperation among nation-states is possible even without a dominant power in the lead role.

Keohane and Nye developed Neoliberalism as a systemic theory, which explains how international institutions facilitate mutual interdependence among nation-states and regulate the behaviour of nation-states. In order to understand the Systems approach of Neoliberalism, we have to understand the concepts such as international institutions, organizations, and regimes according to Neoliberalism. International institutions are defined as ‘sets of rules, principles, and expectations that govern interstate relations’. For instance, ‘liberal trading order’ is an international institution because it has certain rules and principles to serve that purpose and expectations that states open their markets for ensuring the smooth functioning of international trade. Here, the function of the international institution is to help states negotiate and enter into mutually beneficial agreements. International organizations are the formal embodiment of international institutions. In other words, the international institution is a broader realm, and it subsumes an international organization under its concern. For instance, the World Trade Organization is an international organization, which is constituted to serve the purpose of an international institution, i.e., the ‘liberal trading order’. An International organization is featured with a headquarters and other offices, governing council and employees, budgets, and agency to take actions against its member states. The United Nations (UN), the International Monetary Fund (IMF), the World Health Organization (WHO) are the best examples of international organizations. Another key term, often discussed by Neoliberals is

international regime. The term international regime has been used to refer to rules and norms within a particular issue-area. For instance, the Climate Change Regime governs rules and norms to mitigate global climate change. In the same manner, the Nuclear Non-Proliferation Regime is aimed to prevent the spread of nuclear weapons and weapons technology, and TRIPS Regime deals with the Trade-Related Aspects of Intellectual Property Rights. The presence of international institutions has significantly increased since the end of the Cold War. The number of formal international organizations had risen from three hundred in the 1970s to six thousand at the dawn of the 21st century. The function of international institutions, international organizations, and international regimes is to strengthen interdependence. The salient features of Keohane and Nye's Systems Approach are as discussed below.

- A) The Composition of the International System:** As far as Waltz is concerned, the international system is composed of its structure and nation-states as its interacting units. However, according to Keohane and Nye, states are not the only central actors in the international system; rather they expand the scope of the international system by incorporating international institutions and non-state actors into its components. Today it is very clear that international institutions, non-state actors such as transnational corporations and global civil society groups are exerting influence on nation-states. Hence, Neoliberals analyse the role being played by international institutions, organizations, regimes, transnational corporations, and civil society groups in international relations.
- B) Nature of the International System:** Keohane and Nye share with Neorealists the belief that the nature of the international system is anarchical. However, they make an addition that interdependence also is a structural feature of the international system. In other words, both Keohane and Nye argue that the international system is anarchical and interdependent at the same time. The international system is anarchical in the sense that there is no world government above sovereign nation-states and the increasing pace of cross-border transportation, communication, trade and the growing number of international organizations all show that "we live in an era of interdependence". While agreeing with Neorealists that anarchy is a problem as it triggers conflict among nation-states, Keohane and Nye find hope in interdependence that it makes possible the cooperation among nation-states, which eventually alter the nature of the international system.
- C) Regulating Force in the International System:** Keohane and Nye suggest that institutions are functioning as the regulating force in the international system. Institutions create norms that are binding on nation-states and that influence the behaviour of nation-states and change the patterns of international politics. For instance, many nation-states including India had to amend their patent laws to conform to the WTO's guidelines on intellectual property. The role of institutions is increasing in this era of complex interdependence with the presence of a number of actors, other than nation-states, including international organizations, transnational corporations, and global civil society groups. The quintessential example of the growing role of non-state actors in international relations is Greenpeace, which is an international organization engaged in protecting the global environment and promoting peace. They have succeeded in pressurizing governments across the world by gaining public opinion on issues related to the environment, nuclear testing, etc.

Note: i) Use the space given below for your answer,

ii) See the end of the unit for tips for your answer.

1) Write a brief note on the Systems approach of Keohane and Nye?

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5.3.4 Systems Approach of Alexander Wendt

Structural Constructivism, set forth by Alexander Wendt, is noted for its Systems approach. Constructivism as an IR theory that argues that international relations are a social construction. It emphasizes the role of ideational factors such as culture, social values, identity, assumptions, rules, and language in the construction of international relations rather than the material factors such as military capabilities and economic resources. Even though Constructivism emerged in the wave of post positivism/postmodernism/poststructuralism in IR in the late 1980s, Alexander Wendt took a slight deviation and made his version of Constructivism (i.e., Structural Constructivism) compatible with some basic assumptions of Neorealism and Neoliberalism. Major works of Wendt are his article, *Anarchy is what States Make of it: The Social Construction of Power Politics* (1992), and his book, *Social Theory of International Politics* (1999). Salient Features of Wendt's Systems Approach are explained below.

- A) The Composition of the International System:** Like Neorealism and Neoliberalism, Structural Constructivism of Alexander Wendt holds that the international system is composed of its structure and nation-states. However, Wendt differs with Neorealism and Neoliberalism on the elements of the structure. He argues that the structure is made of social relationships. Social relationships are comprised of shared knowledge, social practices, and material resources. The shared or intersubjective knowledge and social practices define who are the enemies, rivals, and friends for one nation-state to another in the international system. For instance, the shared knowledge about each other and their practices accordingly inform the United States and North Korea that both of them are 'enemies' to each other. Most of the member states in the European Union consider one another as 'friends'. Material resources acquire meaning according to shared knowledge and practices. For instance, the nuclear development programme of North Korea will definitely irk the United States. The scaling up of military infrastructure of a member state in the European Union does not cause any tension among its counterparts, because it does not pose any threat to them.
- B) Ideational Factors as the Regulating and Constitutive Force:** As far as Wendt is concerned, the ideational factors such as identity, norms, culture, etc., are functioning as the regulative as well as the constitutive forces that influence the behaviour of nation-states in the international system. For

instance, the identity of a nation-state as 'democratic' country informs it that it should stand for the cause of human rights and democratic values across the world. The ideational factors constitute the interests of nation-states. In other words, ideational factors constitute the interests of nation-states, and it also informs nation-states about the appropriate behaviour in the international system.

- C) The Consequence of Anarchy:** Wendt agrees with Neorealism and Neoliberalism that the nature of the international system is anarchic. However, he has a unique explanation about its consequence. Neorealism of Waltz holds a pessimistic view towards anarchy and suggests that the self-help is the only mechanism to ensure security. This gives a one-sided picture on the consequence of anarchy, a condition of 'war of all against all'. However, Keohane and Nye are optimistic that the ill-effects of the anarchy can be mitigated through institutions. On the contrary, Wendt is neither pessimistic nor optimistic about the consequence of the anarchy. Rather, he is agnostic in this regard and states that 'anarchy is what states make of it', which indicates that the meaning and consequence of anarchy are dependent upon the nature of relationships among nation-states. Wendt further suggests that anarchy can take three principal forms: Hobbesian, Lockean, and Kantian. Enemies create Hobbesian anarchy which is similar to the anarchy depicted by Neorealism. Nation-states, who are in Hobbesian anarchy feel insecure and sometimes pose a threat to world peace. Lockean anarchy is less competitive and is in some respects closer to the anarchy sets forth by Neorealism. The relationships among friends create Kantian anarchy, which is cordial and does not pose any threat to peace.

5.3.5 Systems Approach of Immanuel Wallerstein

Immanuel Wallerstein's Systems approach, known as the World-Systems approach, is the comprehensive version of the dependency theory. Wallerstein sets forth his Systems approach through the following books: *The Modern World-System, Volume 1: Capitalist Agriculture and the Origins of the European World-Economy in the Sixteenth Century* (1974), *The Capitalist World Economy* (1979), *The Modern World-System, Volume 2: Mercantilism and the Consolidation of the European World-Economy, 1600-1750* (1980), *The Modern World-System, Volume 3: The Second Era of Great Expansion of the Capitalist World-Economy, 1730-1840s* (1989), *The Modern World-System, Volume 4: Centrist Liberalism Triumphant, 1789-1914* (2011).

According to Immanuel Wallerstein, the present or the modern world-system is a capitalist one, which emerged in Europe during the period between 1450 and 1650 (this period is also known as the long sixteenth century). Through the process of colonization, this system was extended to North and South America, Asia, and Africa and thereby every region of the world was integrated into a capitalist system. Therefore, the basic argument of Wallerstein is that the world is not a set of independent and separate nation-states. Instead, nation-states are the part of a larger system (i.e., the World-System), which is the set of relatively stable and political relationships, being regulated by the global capital. Therefore he suggests that focussing solely on developments within each nation-state will not bring a clear picture of the developments in the world-system, rather we have to examine the world system as a whole, its regulating force and the interactions of its

components. Salient Features of Wallerstein's Systems Approach are explained below.

A) The Composition of the Modern World-System: According to Wallerstein the key components of the modern World-System are economic zones, nation-states, social classes, and status groups. Economic zones are the classification of the geographical regions on the basis of the division of labour (i.e., economic zones primarily engaged in the production of primary commodities and zones focused on the manufacturing of the most advanced commodities). Wallerstein holds that there are three economic zones on the basis of the division of labour, and they are respectively: 'core', 'peripheral', and 'semi-peripheral'. The 'core' is the technologically advanced zone in the world, or known as the 'global north'. The 'core' specializes in the production of the most advanced commodities and featured by capital-intensive production, the possession of cutting-edge technologies, and the highly developed industries. Due to these factors, the 'core' gets high profits from economic activities. The 'core' is represented by Western Europe, the United States, and Japan. In sharp contrast, the 'peripheral' is the least developed regions in the world, and they are also known as the 'Global South'. The 'peripheral' is engaged in the production of primary commodities. The 'peripheral' economic zone is relatively less technologically sophisticated and more labour intensive than that of the 'core'. Due to these reasons, the 'peripheral' gets low profits from its produces. The 'peripheral' is represented by most regions in Latin America, Asia, and Africa. The 'semi-peripheral' is an area with a mixture of about half "core-like" and half "peripheral-like" activities. The example of 'semi-peripheral' economies is India, China, and South Africa.

The second component of the modern world-system is the nation-state. The modern World-System is politically organized into a sovereign and territorially bound nation-states.

The third component of the modern world-system is social classes. In a capitalist world-system, social classes are formed on the basis of people's relationship to the means of production. Those who own the means of production are the capitalists and those who are deprived of it are the workers. The fourth component of the modern world-system is the status groups, the social groupings based on solidarity derives from cultural identification. Social divisions based on religion, language, race or ethnicity belongs to this category.

B) Nature of the Modern World-System: According to Wallerstein, the modern world-system is capitalist and under this system economic power rests in the hands of those who own the means of production. Since the owners of the means of production (individuals, private corporations, and state organizations) are obsessed with the appropriation of maximum profits, the capitalist modern world-system is inherently exploitative. The capitalists exploit the workers and the core exploits the peripheral states, thereby leading to extreme economic inequalities in the world economy.

C) Regulating Force in the Modern World-System: The regulating force in the modern world-system is the global capital, which organizes the economic activities across the world. Most of the Marxist thinkers, including world-

systems theorists, consider the globalization as an economic transition in which the requirements of global capital are fulfilling through the implementation of neoliberal economic programmes across the world. In this condition, nation-states in the peripheral are restrained by the core, international organizations such as the International Monetary Fund (IMF) and transnational corporations, in accordance with the interests of global capital. For instance, the structural adjustment programmes proposed by the IMF compel several nation-states in the global south to roll-back their welfare programmes. By influencing the prerogative of a nation-state to take the decisions regarding matters under its jurisdiction, the global capital has shown that it is able to challenge the concept of state sovereignty.

Check Your Progress Exercise 4

- Note:** i) Use the space given below for your answer,
 ii) See the end of the unit for tips for your answer.
- 1) Write a short note on the modern world-system.

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5.4 LET US SUM UP

In sum, the behavioural revolution in the 1950s and 1960s initiated the Systems approach to Political Science and IR. Major System theorists to IR are Morton Kaplan, Kenneth Waltz, Robert Keohane, Joseph Nye, Alexander Wendt, and Immanuel Wallerstein. Most of the Systems theorists to IR view the international system, as an integrated whole, made of its structure and nation-states as its primary units. They also argue that the System has a mechanism to control the behaviour of nation-states, therefore, the developments in International Relations is a consequence of the function of the international system rather than that of the result of the domestic factors. The significance of the Systems approach to IR is that it sets forth a distinct framework to analyse International Relations.

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5.6 ANSWERS TO CHECK YOUR PROGRESS EXERCISES

Check Your Progress Exercise 1

- 1) Your answer should highlight the following systems
 - Balance of Power
 - Loose bipolar
 - Tight bipolar
 - Universal
 - Hierarchical
 - Unit veto system.

Check Your Progress Exercise 2

- 1) Your answer should highlight the following points
 - The composition of the International system
 - Distribution of material capabilities as the regulating force
 - Autonomy of the International System

Check Your Progress Exercise 3

- 1) Your answer should highlight the following points
 - International institutions facilitate mutual interdependence among nation-states and regulate the behaviour of nation-states
 - International institutions help states negotiate and enter into mutually beneficial agreements

Check Your Progress Exercise 4

- 1) Your answer should highlight the following points
 - Basic argument of Wallerstein that the world is not a set of independent and separate nation-states
 - Nation-states are the part of a larger system (i.e., the World-System), which is the set of relatively stable and political relationships, being regulated by the global capital
 - We have to examine the world system as a whole, its regulating force and the interactions of its components

